

Career Chart After 10th: Commerce

Commerce: routes, what each opens and closes, and your next move

Last checked October 2026
futurecareerschool.com

Commerce leads to business, accounting, finance and analytics. The Maths decision is the one to take slowly, because it decides how many quantitative doors stay open.

The routes in this chart

COMMERCE

Commerce with Maths · Class 11 and 12 (2 years), then a degree or professional course · about 5 yrs to first full-time work

Accountancy, Business Studies, Economics, Maths

ENTRY

Class 10 pass. Maths in Class 10 helps; some schools ask for a minimum.

BEST FOR

Students who like money, markets, numbers, how businesses make profit, or who come from a family business and want to run it better.

WATCH OUT

Choosing commerce as an easy stream. Accountancy and Economics reward steady practice, and a degree without any applied skill leads to the lowest-paid desk jobs.

WHAT IT KEEPS OPEN

- B.Com, BBA, BMS, economics and statistics degrees
- CA, CMA and CS professional ladders (ICAI has allowed provisional CA Foundation registration after Class 10, and the exam needs Class 12 appearance; confirm the current rule)
- Finance, analytics and actuarial-style routes that need Maths
- Integrated law (BBA LLB) and management routes through CUET or CLAT

WHAT IT CLOSES

- B.Tech / B.E. and NEET medical routes

FIRST MOVE THIS MONTH

Read one company's annual report summary or a small shop's monthly accounts and write what makes its profit rise and fall.

COMMERCE

Commerce without Maths · Class 11 and 12 (2 years), then a degree or professional course · about 5 yrs to first full-time work

Accountancy, Business Studies, Economics, plus an elective

ENTRY

Class 10 pass.

BEST FOR

Students who want business or accounting but are sure Maths will not carry them for two more years.

WATCH OUT

Dropping Maths without checking the programmes you may want later. Some doors can be reopened with bridge courses, but it costs time.

WHAT IT KEEPS OPEN

- B.Com, BBA, BMS and most business and accounting degrees
- CA, CMA and CS routes
- Integrated law and CUET-based BA and B.Com courses

WHAT IT CLOSES

- Quantitative economics honours and some analytics or actuarial programmes that ask for Class 12 Maths
- B.Tech / B.E. and NEET medical routes

FIRST MOVE THIS MONTH

List three degrees you might want after Class 12 and check each one's Class 12 subject rule on its own admission page.

Time to first full-time work



Years counted from the day Class 10 ends to the earliest standard full-time start. They show time, not pay. Postgraduate study, repeat attempts and licensing exams add years in some routes.

Five mistakes to avoid

- **Choosing by marks alone.** High marks tell you what you can enter, not what you can sustain for two to five years.
- **Copying friends or relatives.** The route that worked for a cousin worked for their strengths, money and city.
- **Dropping Maths or Biology without checking.** Maths is needed for B.Tech and Biology for NEET medical seats. Check what you may want before you drop either.

- **Paying before verifying.** Check that the institute is approved, the fee is the total fee and the course is recognised.
- **Treating the route as the whole plan.** Every route leads to crowded and well-paid rows alike. The skill layer on top is what separates them.

Test every route you shortlist: the 4 checkpoints

1 Biology

How do you actually work best: abstract study, business thinking, people, or tools and systems? Choose the daily reality, not the label.

2 Context

Marks, money, family situation, school options, commute and emotional readiness. A route right on paper can be wrong for now.

3 Market

Where does the route lead later: real roles, real skills, real progression? Map it forward before you choose.

4 Survival

Will it hold up in an AI-shaped market? Domain skill plus communication, digital fluency and judgment lasts longer than routine work.

Then pass the 3 gates before money or years are locked in

1 Proof of Skill

Complete one small real task that resembles the route before you lock it.

2 Proof of Communication

Explain in 30 to 90 seconds why the route fits you, where it leads and what you will test next.

3 Proof of Value

Get grounded feedback from a teacher, senior or professional who does this work, and pressure-test your reasoning.

Your one-page plan (write it, do not just read it)

Route I am leaning toward:

Second route I would accept:

Subjects or trade I need for it:

The exam or entry rule I verified, and where:

One small real task I will finish this month:

The person I will ask for feedback:

Verify on the official source before you pay

SOURCE	USE IT FOR	LINK
NIOS (open schooling)	Open-school Secondary and Senior Secondary, vocational courses, study centres. The site states that the Association of Indian Universities has issued equivalence for the NIOS Senior Secondary certificate.	www.nios.ac.in/
DGT Craftsmen Training Scheme (ITI)	How the ITI network works. The page lists 14,643 ITIs and 169 NSQF-compliant trades (checked October 2026).	dgt.gov.in/en/CTS
NATS (apprenticeship training)	Apprenticeship-style, learn-while-working training for diploma and technical graduates.	nats.education.gov.in/about-us.php
AICTE	Check that a diploma or engineering institute is approved before paying.	www.aicte-india.org/
NTA (JEE Main, NEET UG, CUET UG)	Exam eligibility, syllabus and dates for the entrance tests that start after Class 12.	nta.ac.in/

Read this first: Entry rules, minimum marks, fees and seat numbers differ by state, board and year. Treat this chart as a map for asking better questions, then confirm every rule on the official site before you pay or lock a subject.

The route is the base layer. The skill portfolio on top raises your ceiling.

Find your strongest direction with the free Class 10 and below career assessment: futurecareerschool.com/services/assessments/class-10-and-below/

Personal help for you and your family: futurecareerschool.com/services/career-counselling-and-career-guidance/ · WhatsApp message from the site.

Full guide with explanations: futurecareerschool.com/blog/stream-selection/career-chart-after-10th/

Compare with the other routes in the [full career chart after 10th](#).